



You can find product reviews and cost comparisons on the Internet—just be sure the source is reliable and impartial. One good site is www.consumerworld.org, with product reviews, price comparisons, airfare and travel deals, and lots of other consumer resources.

Avoid the Holiday Hangover

If you're like most people, you tend to go overboard on holiday spending, but you can avoid overspending on gifts by setting spending limits. Using your budget, figure out how much you can realistically afford to spend on gifts without going into debt. Make a list of all the people you'd like to buy gifts for, including the small gifts for babysitters, teachers, newspaper carriers, and so on. Set a limit for each person on your list, then add up all the amounts and make sure they don't exceed your overall spending limit. Try to allow a cushion for unexpected items or price fluctuations.



The Internet is a rich source of advice on being frugal, a word that sometimes has a bad connotation but that simply means economy in the use of resources. It's amazing how many different ways there are to cut costs and save money. Do a little Internet surfing and you'll find hundreds of ideas that have worked for others. Being frugal can be fun!

Finding the Fat